

Osman Berke Yıldırım

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The Pennsylvania State University, State College, PA

Education

The Pennsylvania State University — *State College, PA*
Dual PhD in Political Science & Social Data Analytics — Fall 2026 - Expected 2031 June

- University Graduate Fellowship (Fall 2026), Distinguished Graduate Fellowship (Spring 2027)

Sabancı University — *Istanbul, Turkey*
MA in Political Science — Spring 2024 - Expected 2026 June

- Full scholarship - GPA: 3.96/4.00
- Courses: Advanced Methods and Analysis in Political Science, Methods and Scope of Political Analysis, Quantitative Research Methods
- Methods: OLS, QGIS, DiD, GRDD, Matching, Text Analysis

Sabancı University — *Istanbul, Turkey*
BA in Political Science
Double Major: BSc in Computer Science & Engineering — 2019 – 2024

- Full scholarship
- Graduated (GPA: 3.47/4.00)

Working Papers

Foreign Occupation, Local Resistance, and State Capacity: A Subnational Analysis
Project — Spring 2024

- *Constructed* geocoded dataset for Turkish districts to exploit Turkish War of Independence on the fiscal and legal capacity
- Supervisor: Asst. Prof. Adee Weller

Administrative Continuity and State Capacity: Quasi-Natural Experiment Example from the Ottoman-Greek Divide — *Sabancı University*
Project - Draft available upon request — Spring 2025

- *Investigated* whether the 1832 Ottoman–Greek border generated persistent economic disparities across adjacent municipalities
- *Compiled* municipal-level GDP (2021), VIIRS night-light (2020), and geocoded administrative boundary datasets for quasi-experimental analysis
- *Applied* OLS and geographic regression discontinuity (GRDD) models to estimate institutional legacy effects on contemporary economic activity
- *Integrated* geographic and infrastructural controls (distance to ports, road networks, elevation, terrain ruggedness) to strengthen causal inference
- *Identified* slope-based discontinuities suggesting modest positive long-run development patterns on the former Ottoman side
- Supervisor: Asst. Prof. Fatih Serkant Adıgüzel, & Assoc. Prof. Mert Moral

Experience

Research Assistant *Georgia State University & Liverpool University*
Higher Education & Authoritarian Consolidation in Turkey Summer & Fall 2025

- *Collected* comprehensive data on election results at the district(ilçe) level from 1987 to 2024 for both general and local elections
- *Cleaned* spatial data, geocoded and applied historical administrative unit mapping to match modern-day district boundaries
- *Combined* control variables such as employment, population census, DMSP-OLS & VIIRS night-light with electoral data for final analysis
- Supervisor: Asst. Prof. Felix Wiebrecht & Dr. Ozlem Tuncel

Teaching Assistant, SPS 102 *Sabancı University*
Humanity & Society II Fall & Spring 2024

- *Led* weekly discussion sections and held office hours for 50+ students
- *Graded* midterms, essays, and final papers with feedback

Academic Intern *Norwegian University of Science & Technology*
Advisor: Prof. Andrew Perkis Summer 2024

- *Worked* full time in a multidisciplinary academic team
- *Reported* a research protocol about designing a social scientific evaluation study for AR/VR games and its impact on public awareness of water treatment facilities across Europe as part of the EU funded ULTIMATE Water Project

Academic Intern *Boğaziçi University*
Advisor: As. Prof. Başak Taraktaş Summer 2024

- *Learned and improved* on Complexity Science and Agent Based Modelling using NetLogo software
- *Conducted* literature review, about certain features that may affect protester behaviour and improved the Agent Based Model using hyper tuning and additional features.

Peer Moderator and General Coordinator, SPS 102 *Sabancı University*
History and Political Thought March 2020 - January 2024

- *Moderated* tutoring sessions for freshmen social and political sciences courses
- *Organized and oversaw* weekly session schedules and managed a team of 30+ peer moderators

MA Dissertation

Once We Were Brothers: Forced Migration, Agricultural Mismatch, and Electoral Behavior; Evidence from the 1923 Lausanne Population Exchange *Sabancı University*
MA Thesis Spring 2026

- *Constructed* a novel neighborhood-level dataset covering 51,297 Turkish settlements, combining historical population-exchange exposure, agricultural production, geographic, and electoral data
- *Employed* entropy balancing, coarsened exact matching, and difference-in-differences to estimate the long-run effects of the 1923 Lausanne Population Exchange on agricultural production and electoral behavior
- *Analyzed* electoral outcomes from the 1991 and 2023 elections and implemented causal mediation analysis to examine whether agricultural production accounts for the political legacy of forced migration
- *Found* persistent differences in agricultural production, opposition support, incumbent support, and turnout between historically exchange-exposed and comparable non-exposed settlements
- Supervisor: Asst. Prof. Fatih Serkant Adıgüzel & Assoc. Prof. Mert Moral

From Divine Right to Secular Consent: The Transformation of Political Legitimacy from Charlemagne to Hobbes *Sabancı University*
Project Spring 2024

- *Analyzed* the development of the concept of legitimacy and sovereignty historically and examined the political

theory evolution in medieval and pre-modern texts

- Supervisor: Prof. Ahmet Evin

Radio Signal Propagation Estimation *Sabancı University*
Project Fall 2024

- *Programmed* python script for an API to access propagation data of transmitter using topographical estimation
- *Planning* on collecting data using ITM(Irregular Terrain Model) for calculating propagation of Kurdish Radio in Yerevan and analyzing its impact in Kurdish citizens
- Supervisor: Asst. Prof. Fatih Serkant Adıgüzel, & Assoc. Prof. Aslı Cansunar

Conferences

Political Science Department Term Conference *Sabancı University / Istanbul*
Administrative Continuity and State Capacity:
Quasi-Natural Experiment Example from the Ottoman-Greek Divide Spring 2025

- Supervisor: Assoc. Prof. Mert Moral

Skills

- Languages: Turkish (native), English (C1), German (A1), Ottoman Script (Beginner)
- Software: R, Stata, LaTeX, Netlogo, Python (Advanced), C (Intermediate), C++ (Intermediate), C# (Intermediate), Dart & Flutter (Intermediate), SQL & MySQL (Intermediate), Linux (Ubuntu, Kali) OS (Advanced), Web Development (React & Node.js) (Intermediate)

References

- Assoc. Prof. Mert Moral, Sabancı University, Political Science
- Assoc. Prof. Berk Esen, Sabancı University, Political Science
- Asst. Prof. Felix Wiebrecht Esen, Liverpool University, Politics
- Asst. Prof. Fatih Serkant Adıgüzel, Sabancı University, Political Science